

ARTICLES OF DISCIPLINE

A Personal Covenant of Military Calisthenics and Nutritional Restraint

Term: Three Hundred and Sixty-Five (365) Consecutive Days

PARTIES

This Covenant is made and entered into on the _____ day of _____, 20_____
(the **COMMENCEMENT DATE**), by and between:

- (a) **AHMAD SHABAZZ**, in his capacity as the man who must rise, train, weigh, measure, refuse, and endure (the **OBLIGOR**); and
- (b) **AHMAD SHABAZZ**, in his capacity as the man who will inherit the body, the discipline, the years, and the example set before his children (the **OBLIGEE**).

The Obligor and the Obligee are one and the same person. That fact does not diminish this Covenant. It is its entire force. A promise made to another may be renegotiated. A promise made to oneself, in ink, may only be kept or betrayed.

RECITALS

WHEREAS the Obligor has determined that the governing failure of his physical life has not been ignorance, capacity, or opportunity, but the absence of an enforceable standard;

WHEREAS motivation is an unreliable counterparty, appearing without notice and departing without cause, and cannot be relied upon to perform;

WHEREAS discipline is not a feeling to be summoned but an obligation to be discharged, and is therefore properly the subject of a contract rather than an intention;

WHEREAS the Obligor has observed that habits do not die on the day they are broken, but on the second day, and has resolved to make the second day legally impossible;

WHEREAS the Obligor intends that the standard survive the attainment of its own object, so that the result achieved is held rather than surrendered;

WHEREAS the Obligor is the father of **Rashidah, Rahim, Rakim, Razim, and Rochadah**, who are learning, at this moment and without being taught, what a man's word is worth by observing what their father does with his own;

AND WHEREAS the Obligor accepts that they will not remember what he intended, resolved, or explained, but only what he did on the days it was inconvenient;

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants below, and of the years of health, strength, and self-command to be gained thereby, the Obligor binds himself as follows.

ARTICLE I — DEFINITIONS

- 1.1 **THE APP** means CoreForge, the Obligor's calisthenics training application, together with any successor application he adopts and records under Schedule C.
- 1.2 **PRESCRIBED SESSION** means the session the App presents as next due on the Obligor's programme — its warm-up, its four main slots, its finisher, at the targets the App computes — performed to completion and logged in the App.
- 1.3 **QUALIFYING SESSION** means a Prescribed Session completed in full. A partial session, a substituted session, a walk, a stretch, a Quick Workout, or a day of manual labour is *not* a Qualifying Session, however tired it leaves the Obligor.
- 1.4 **TRAINING DAY** means any calendar day on which a Qualifying Session is completed.
- 1.5 **CALENDAR DAY** runs from 00:00 to 23:59 local time at the Obligor's location. A session begun before midnight and completed after it is credited to the day on which it began.
- 1.6 **TDEE** means Total Daily Energy Expenditure, calculated by the Mifflin–St Jeor equation as implemented in the App's Fuel tab, using the Obligor's then-current weight, height, age, and activity setting.
- 1.7 **DAILY CEILING** means eighty-five percent (85%) of TDEE, rounded down to the nearest ten (10) kilocalories, being a deficit of fifteen percent (15%).
- 1.8 **BREACH** means any failure to perform an obligation under Articles III or IV, whether or not the Obligor intended it, remembers it, or feels it was deserved.
- 1.9 **THE FUND** means the account or instrument designated in Article VII, held for the benefit of the Obligor's children.

ARTICLE II — TERM

- 2.1 This Covenant takes effect at 00:00 on the Commencement Date and expires at 23:59 on the three hundred and sixty-fifth (365th) day thereafter (the **TERM**).
- 2.2 The Term is not suspended by holidays, birthdays, religious observance, celebration, travel, bereavement, business obligation, or the Obligor's success. It runs continuously.
- 2.3 There is no clause permitting early termination. The Obligor may, of course, physically stop. He may not do so lawfully under this instrument, and Article VII will follow him for every day remaining.

ARTICLE III — THE TRAINING COVENANT (THE TWO-DAY RULE)

PRINCIPAL OBLIGATION

The Obligor shall not permit two (2) consecutive Calendar Days to pass without a Qualifying Session.

- 3.1 Accordingly, at no point during the Term shall the interval between the end of one Training Day and the start of the next exceed one (1) intervening rest day.
- 3.2 For the avoidance of doubt: if the Obligor trains on Monday and does not train on Tuesday, then Wednesday is **not optional**. It is due. It is owed. It is a debt, and it falls due at 00:00 and is in default at 23:59.
- 3.3 A single rest day is a right. A second is a Breach. The Obligor is entitled to rest; he is not entitled to drift.
- 3.4 This Rule imposes a floor of not fewer than three (3) Qualifying Sessions in any rolling seven (7) day period. The Obligor's programme prescribes four (4). The floor is not the target; it is the point below which he has broken his word.
- 3.5 Sessions may not be banked. Two sessions on one day do not purchase a second rest day. The Rule is about the *rhythm*, not the volume, and rhythm cannot be paid forward.
- 3.6 Nor may sessions be borrowed. A session promised for tomorrow does not discharge today.
- 3.7 The Obligor shall perform the Prescribed Session as the App computes it, including its adaptive overload multiplier. He shall answer the App's post-session difficulty prompt honestly. Understating effort to lower future targets is a Breach of this Article, not merely a discourtesy to the machine.

ARTICLE IV — THE NUTRITION COVENANT

PRINCIPAL OBLIGATION

The Obligor shall not exceed the Daily Ceiling on any Calendar Day of the Term, and shall remain in a caloric deficit of fifteen percent (15%) below TDEE every day, including after the physical objective of this Covenant has been attained.

- 4.1 The Daily Ceiling is a ceiling and not a target range. Consumption at or below it performs; consumption above it, by any margin, breaches.
- 4.2 All intake shall be logged in the App on the day it is consumed. Food unlogged is presumed consumed at its highest plausible value. The Obligor may not benefit from his own incomplete records.
- 4.3 Liquid calories, alcohol, condiments, cooking oil, and food eaten standing at the counter are food and count in full. Nothing is exempt by reason of being consumed quickly, unhappily, or in company.

Recalculation — so the deficit stays 15%, and never quietly becomes 30%

- 4.4 TDEE shall be recalculated, and a new Daily Ceiling entered in Schedule A, upon the earlier of: (a) the expiry of each ninety (90) days of the Term; or (b) any change in bodyweight of five (5) kilograms or more from the

weight used in the current calculation.

- 4.5 The obligation is to the *percentage*, not to the number. As the Obligor grows lighter, his TDEE falls and his Ceiling falls with it. He does not get to keep eating at last quarter's allowance; equally, he is never bound to a number that has silently become a starvation ration.

Physiological floor

- 4.6 The Daily Ceiling shall not in any event fall below one thousand five hundred (1,500) kilocalories per day without the written direction of a licensed physician recorded in Schedule C. A deficit that destroys the body it was meant to build is not performance of this Covenant but a different kind of breach.
- 4.7 The Obligor shall meet a protein intake of not less than the App's computed target (approximately 1.8 g per kilogram of bodyweight) within the Daily Ceiling, so that the weight surrendered is fat and not the muscle he is training to build.
- 4.8 If a licensed physician directs in writing that the deficit be suspended for a medical reason, that direction governs, is recorded in Schedule C, and its period is not a Breach. No other authority may suspend this Article — not appetite, not occasion, not the Obligor's own reasoning at eleven o'clock at night.

ARTICLE V — EXCUSED ABSENCE

- 5.1 The obligation in Article III is suspended, and the two-day clock tolled, only for the following, and for no other cause:
- (a) **Illness** — fever, vomiting, active infection, or an illness for which a physician has advised rest.
 - (b) **Injury** — an acute injury which makes the Prescribed Session unsafe to perform.
- 5.2 Excused Absence must be recorded in Schedule D on the day it arises, stating the cause and the date. An absence explained after the fact, or explained only in the mind, is a Breach.
- 5.3 Where an injury disables one region only, the Obligor shall train what remains sound. A sprained ankle does not excuse the upper body. Partial incapacity excuses partial performance and no more.
- 5.4 On the first Calendar Day on which the cause of excuse has ended, the two-day clock resumes and a Qualifying Session is due within two (2) days.

VOID DEFENCES

The following are expressly recorded as **not** constituting excuse under this Article, and the Obligor waives each of them now, in advance, while he is clear-headed and before he needs them:

Travel · a late night · a long working day · an early flight · soreness · fatigue · low mood · lack of motivation · bad weather · no equipment · no space · house guests · a holiday · a celebration · a funeral of the appetite · being *too busy* · having *already been active* · having trained hard yesterday · intending sincerely to train tomorrow · the belief, arriving always at the same hour, that one day will not matter.

- 5.5 **The Nutrition Covenant admits no excuse whatsoever.** Illness and injury suspend training; they do not suspend Article IV. A man who cannot train can still refrain.

ARTICLE VI — RECORD AND PROOF

- 6.1 The App's log is the register of performance under this Covenant and is conclusive evidence of it.
- 6.2 The burden of proof lies on the Obligor. **An unlogged day is a breached day.** There is no defence of *I did train, I simply did not record it*.
- 6.3 The Obligor shall review the register on the first day of each month, determine any Breaches arising in the preceding month, enter them in Schedule B, and initial the monthly attestation in Schedule E in ink.
- 6.4 The Obligor is both the party bound and the auditor of his own performance. He therefore undertakes the harder obligation: to judge himself as a stranger would, without the discount he extends to himself by habit.

ARTICLE VII — BREACH AND LIQUIDATED DAMAGES

- 7.1 Upon each Breach, the Obligor shall pay the sum of _____ (_____ dollars) into the Fund, being an account, trust, or instrument held for the benefit of his children and designated in Schedule C.
- 7.2 Payment falls due within seven (7) days of the Breach. Non-payment is itself a Breach and attracts a further sum.
- 7.3 Each breached day is a separate Breach and attracts a separate sum. A week of neglect is seven Breaches, not one.
- 7.4 Where a Breach of the same Article occurs a second time within the same calendar month, the sum for that second and each subsequent Breach in that month is **doubled**. Repetition is the thing this Covenant exists to prevent, and it is priced accordingly.
- 7.5 The sum is not a penalty to be resented but liquidated damages agreed in advance, in recognition that the true loss — a year of the Obligor's health, and the example his children take from watching whether their father keeps his word — cannot be computed.
- 7.6 **Damages may not be worked off.** Extra sessions, longer sessions, or a stricter week do not discharge a sum owed. The Obligor may not train his way out of a debt; he must pay it and then train anyway.
- 7.7 The Obligor shall not disclose to Rashidah, Rahim, Rakim, Razim, or Rochadah that any payment arose from a Breach. The money is theirs regardless, and they are to receive it without explanation, without ceremony, and without knowing what it cost their father to owe it. He alone carries the knowledge of how it was earned. That knowledge — not the sum — is the whole of the penalty, and it is sufficient.

ARTICLE VIII — AMENDMENT

- 8.1 No term of this Covenant may be amended, waived, relaxed, or reinterpreted except by an instrument in writing, entered in Schedule C, handwritten in ink, and signed and dated by the Obligor.
- 8.2 **No amendment has retroactive effect.** The Obligor may not amend a term in order to excuse a Breach already committed, nor on the day of a Breach, nor within seven (7) days after one. Amendment is an instrument of

honest revision, not of escape.

- 8.3** No oral modification. No modification by intention, by resolution, or by a conversation held with oneself while lying down.
- 8.4** Amendment may make this Covenant stricter at any time and without restriction.

ARTICLE IX — GENERAL PROVISIONS

- 9.1 NO WAIVER.** A failure to enforce a term on one occasion is not a waiver of that term, and does not create a practice, precedent, or expectation. Every day stands alone.
- 9.2 SEVERABILITY.** If any provision is found unworkable in practice, it shall be amended under Article VIII, and every other provision remains in full force. The failure of a clause is not the failure of the Covenant.
- 9.3 ENTIRE AGREEMENT.** This document supersedes every prior resolution, new year's promise, private vow, and silent intention made by the Obligor on this subject, all of which are hereby acknowledged to have failed for want of a written form.
- 9.4 GOVERNING SPIRIT.** Where a provision is ambiguous, it shall be construed against the Obligor and in favour of the harder reading. He wrote it. He knew what he meant.
- 9.5 RENEWAL.** Not fewer than thirty (30) days before expiry, the Obligor shall determine whether to execute a further Covenant for a successive Term. This one ends. What it built is meant to outlast it.

ARTICLE X — DECLARATION AND EXECUTION

I, **AHMAD SHABAZZ**, declare that I have read every word of this instrument; that I understand precisely what I am binding myself to; that I sign it of my own will, free of coercion, and in full possession of the knowledge that no one will enforce it but me.

I acknowledge that I have failed at this before, and that the difference between then and now is not that I want it more, but that this time it is *written*, and that I have signed it in ink that cannot be edited, deleted, or quietly revised at midnight.

I will not let two days pass. I will not exceed the ceiling. I will do this on the days I want to and on the days I do not, and the second kind is the only kind that has ever counted.

Signed, sealed, and delivered as a deed.

SIGNATURE OF THE OBLIGOR

SIGNATURE OF THE OBLIGEE (the same hand, the same man)

PRINT NAME — AHMAD SHABAZZ

DATE AND PLACE OF SIGNING

The following block is optional. A witness holds no power under this Covenant and bears no duty of enforcement. Their only function is that a second person now knows.

SIGNATURE OF WITNESS

PRINT NAME OF WITNESS · DATE

SCHEDULE A — ENERGY CALCULATION AND QUARTERLY RECALCULATION

Complete on the Commencement Date and on each recalculation required by clause 4.4. All figures in the Obligor's own hand.

DATE	WEIGHT	TDEE (KCAL)	DAILY CEILING (TDEE × 0.85)	PROTEIN TARGET	WAIST	INITIALS
Commencement						
Day 90						
Day 180						
Day 270						
Day 365						
Interim (5 kg change)						
Interim (5 kg change)						
Interim (5 kg change)						

SCHEDULE B — REGISTER OF BREACHES

Entered on the first day of each month under clause 6.3. Every line is to be completed in full, including the last column. Leaving a line half-finished is itself a failure of Article VI.

[illegible]

SCHEDULE C — DESIGNATIONS AND AMENDMENTS

C.1 — The Fund. The account, trust, or instrument held for the benefit of the Obligor's children, into which all sums under Article VII are paid:

The beneficiaries, being the Obligor's children, are: **Rashidah, Rahim, Rakim, Razim,** and **Rochadah.**

C.2 — The App. The application governing the Prescribed Session under clause 1.1: CoreForge

Any successor application adopted during the Term is to be recorded as an amendment below.

C.3 — Amendments. Handwritten only. Subject in every case to clause 8.2 (no retroactive effect; none within seven days of a Breach).

DATE	CLAUSE AMENDED	AMENDMENT, IN THE OBLIGOR'S HAND	SIGNATURE

SCHEDULE D — REGISTER OF EXCUSED ABSENCE

Recorded on the day the absence arises, per clause 5.2. Late entries do not excuse.

DATE(S)	ILLNESS OR INJURY	NATURE OF IT	WHAT WAS STILL TRAINED (CL. 5.3)	DATE RESUMED

SCHEDULE E — MONTHLY ATTESTATION

On the first day of each month, having reviewed the register, the Obligor signs the line below. The signature attests: *I have looked at the record honestly, and Schedule B is complete.*

MONTH	TRAINING DAYS	BREACHES RECORDED	SUMS PAID	SIGNATURE
Month 1				
Month 2				
Month 3				
Month 4				
Month 5				
Month 6				
Month 7				
Month 8				
Month 9				
Month 10				
Month 11				
Month 12				

ENDORSEMENT UPON COMPLETION OF THE TERM

On the three hundred and sixty-fifth day, the Obligor may write here what he could not have written on the first:

Signed _____ Dated _____

— END OF INSTRUMENT —